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SPONSOR COMPLIANCE AUDITS



LATEST NEWS: Full UK ETA Enforcement Announced for February 2026 (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/full-uk-eta-enforcen>

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SPONSOR COMPLIANCE AUDITS

If you hold a sponsor licence, a Home Office sponsor compliance visit is inevitable, either as part of your sponsor licence application or during your licence period. This ensures that your sponsor licence application details are accurate and that you are complying with the ongoing duties and responsibilities of a licensed sponsor. To safeguard your business, a comprehensive mock sponsor compliance audit or immigration audit is recommended in advance of a sponsor compliance visit.

Our experienced immigration barristers can conduct a thorough immigration audit of your business ahead of a Home Office sponsor compliance visit, ensuring that you meet Home Office requirements and are fully prepared for any compliance visit. By addressing potential issues proactively through a mock immigration audit, you can avoid the serious consequences of non-compliance, including licence suspension or revocation.

What Happens During a Home Office Sponsor Compliance Visit?

When Home Office sponsor compliance officers visit your business premises they will check that:

- Information that has been given to UKVI is accurate and complete
- You are able to offer employment at the Skilled Worker skill level
- You are genuine and trading or operating lawfully in the UK
- There are no reasons to believe you represent a threat to immigration control
- You are committed to, and actually are, complying with all the duties of sponsorship

During a Home Office sponsor compliance visit you can expect your record keeping, reporting and immigration status monitoring processes and documentation to be reviewed in order to ensure that you remain compliant.

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The compliance officer may not give an indication of their assessment of your ability to comply with sponsor duties during the visit.

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What Else Do I Need to Know about Home Office Sponsor Compliance Visits?

The Home Office

(<https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/658319f2ed3c34000d3bfcb6/Points-based+system+sponsor+compliance+visits.pdf>) may check sponsors at random. These sponsor compliance visits can be announced or unannounced.

If your migrant workers perform their employment duties at a third party's office, it is your responsibility to ensure that the third party is aware of the possibility of unplanned and unannounced visits and checks being conducted at their premises and ensure their full cooperation.

If the compliance officers discover a problem before making a decision on your sponsor licence application then the application may be refused.

If the compliance officers find discrepancies in your application after a decision has already been made to grant or renew your sponsor licence, they will take action against you. This could result in your licence being revoked, suspended, or downgraded, with repercussions for sponsored employees.

The ratings of all licensed sponsors are on the Home Office website. A downgrade could result in negative publicity and reputational damage.

If the Home Office considers that you have attempted deception in your sponsor licence application then this could result in prosecution.

How a Mock Sponsor Compliance Audit by Our Immigration Barristers Can Help

Our immigration barristers can draw on their experience of Home Office compliance requirements to conduct a mock sponsor compliance audit or immigration audit of your business in advance of any Home Office sponsor compliance inspection.

Offering invaluable insights into Home Office practice and procedure during compliance visits, an immigration audit by our barristers will ensure that you, as a sponsor, are operating in compliance with the Government's immigration compliance regime and are well prepared for a Home Office visit.

During our mock sponsor compliance audit, a specialist business immigration barrister will:

- Verify information that you gave on your sponsor licence application
- Check your document management and record-keeping systems to ensure that you are complying with all of your sponsor duties (or will be able to comply if your licence

- application has not yet been decided)
- Review the personnel files of any sponsored migrants to identify any deficiencies and areas for improvement
 - Interview any of your employees involved in the recruitment of migrant workers to prepare them for the type of questions that a Home Office inspector is likely to ask
 - Speak to any migrant workers to determine whether they are familiar with the terms and conditions of their UK visas
 - Conduct checks on other workers to ensure you are complying with your obligation to prevent illegal working

Following our mock immigration audit, you will receive a comprehensive written report prepared by the immigration barrister who conducted the sponsorship compliance audit identifying risk areas and providing expert recommendations for improvement.

If required, we can undertake a follow-up sponsor compliance audit to further assess any changes that have been implemented.

Contact our Immigration Barristers

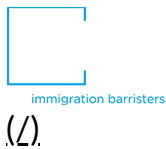
To arrange a mock sponsor compliance audit of your business before you receive a Home Office sponsor compliance visit, contact our immigration compliance team on 0203 617 9173 or complete our enquiry form below.

WE CAN ALSO ASSIST WITH

Sponsor Licence Applications	+
Sponsor Licence Renewals	+
Sponsor Licence Suspensions and Revocations	+
Sponsor Licence Refusals	+

WHAT CAN WE HELP YOU WITH?

To arrange an initial consultation meeting with one of our immigration barristers, contact our business immigration team on 0203 617 9173 or complete our enquiry form.



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LATEST ARTICLES EXPERT COMMENT AND INSIGHT FROM OUR IMMIGRATION TEAM

Client Success: UK Healthcare Consultancy Approved for Self-Sponsorship Sponsor Licence

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/client-success/client-success-uk-healthcare-consultancy-approved-for-self-sponsorship-sponsor-licence/>)

By Richmond Chambers -

03 Oct 2025

A healthcare consultancy has successfully secured a Sponsor Licence through self-sponsorship, allowing it to establish UK operations under the leadership of its founder.

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/client-success/client-success-uk-healthcare-consultancy-approved-for-self-sponsorship-sponsor-licence/>)

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Immigration Skills Charge - A Guide for Employers

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/immigration-skills-charge-a-guide-for-employers/>)

By Georgina Griggs - Immigration Barrister

22 Sep 2025

The UK Immigration Skills Charge ("ISC") is a fee that UK employers must pay for each migrant worker that is sponsored in the Skilled Worker or Global Business Mobility – Senior or Specialist Worker categories, unless an exemption applies.

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/immigration-skills-charge-a-guide-for-employers/>)

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UK Expansion Worker Sponsor Licence Guidance [2025 Updates]

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/uk-expansion-worker-sponsor-licence-guidance-2025-updates/>)

By Annie Ee - Senior Legal Associate

25 Apr 2025

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(/). In This Article 1. Overview of the UK Expansion Worker Route 2. Demonstrating a UK Presence for Sponsor Licence Applications 3. Proving a Qualifying Link Between UK and Overseas Entities 4. Evidence of Overseas Operations:...

(https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/uk-expansion-worker-sponsor-licence-guidance-2025-updates/)

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